in India, while many awaited a return to Burma as they had left all aspects of their lives back there.

Between 1942 and 1945, policies and legislative debates over resettlement of the Burma refugees took place even though major Indian political leaders were behind bars for their activities during the Quit India Movement. Refugees had also arrived in India from other parts of South East Asia that Japan had attacked, but Burma was clearly the special case as was reflected in the formation of a dedicated Burmese Refugee Association. Provincial governments opened employment bureaus for those who had returned from Burma, subsistence allowance was provided for and university fees were waived for students. In early 1945, Burma was re-occupied by the British and the refugees could return following an agreement between the governments of India and Burma later that year. However, only a fourth of the evacuees went back.[10] Shamshad Begum's *Mere Piya Gaye Rangoon* was sung against the backdrop of this upheaval.

Following Burmese Independence in 1948, new citizenship, immigration and land nationalization laws were introduced that hurt the interests of Indian labour and capital. With the advent of military dictatorship in 1962 and nationalization of various sectors, people of Indian origin began leaving by the thousands over the next two decades. Unresolved claims on assets and business properties implied that the returnees often came back empty-handed. Most headed for their provinces or states of origin while some relocated to other countries. Until 2001, Tamil Nadu, an important source of Indian settlers in Burma, had rehabilitated nearly 1,50,000 returnees.[11] Rehabilitation measures included land grants and loan facilities for housing the returnees after they spent time in temporary transit camps. Major 'Burma Colonies' sprung up in New Delhi, Jaipur, Bhopal, Patna, Kolkata, Moreh (Manipur), Vishakapatnam, Vellore, Chennai, Trichy and Madurai as families of the returnees reassimilated into Indian society.[12]

Just as the repatriation policies regarding Indian settlers in Burma were winding down in the 1980s, a new refugee problem arose. Hundreds of native Burmese students crossed over into India in 1988 to escape the backlash against their pro-democracy protests. Over the next decade, the